



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

May 2017

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for August is

July 21

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

June & July

SUNDAY WORSHIP -SUMMER SCHEDULE BEGINS JUNE 18

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:30am Outdoor Worship with band and vocals,
weather permitting.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in June

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
				1 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	2 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	3 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 3:30p Brighter Minds Recitals
4 Pentecost Bike Blessing Communion 10a Pentecost Worship 11a Garden Party 2p Brighter Minds Recitals 6p Living Brave Women's Group 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	5 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance	6 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p HCI 6:30p Toastmasters	7 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	8 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	9 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved	10 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
11 Trinity Sunday PICTURES 10a Baccalaureate 7p SAA	12 PICTURES 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	13 PICTURES 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	14 Flag Day 11:30a UMW Picnic 5p Methodicals	15 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	16 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	17 Garage Sale 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
18 Father's Day 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	19 Annual Confe. <i>Music & Drama Camp</i> VBS 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Women's Soul Group	20 Annual Confe. <i>Music & Drama Camp</i> VBS 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (	21 Summer Solstice Annual Confe. <i>Music & Drama Camp</i> VBS 5p Methodicals	22 Annual Confe. <i>Music & Drama Camp</i> VBS 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	23 Annual Confe. <i>Music & Drama Camp</i> VBS 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Music & Drama performance	24 6a Joy Catering 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
25 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 7p SAA	26 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	27 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	28 5p Methodicals	29 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	30 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	Notes:

Minnehaha Happenings in July

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
						1 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
2 Communion 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	3 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	4 Independence Day 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	5 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	6 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	7 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	8 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
9 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 7p SAA	10 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance	11 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	12 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals	13 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	14 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved	15 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
16 <i>Minnehaha Adventure Camp</i> 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	17 <i>Minnehaha Adventure Camp</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Women's Soul Group	18 <i>Minnehaha Adventure Camp</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	19 5p Methodicals	20 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	21 <i>Newsletter items due</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	22 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
23 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Outdoor Worship 7p SAA	24 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	25 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	26 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 5p Methodicals	27 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	28 <i>Minnehaha Wilderness Camp</i> 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	29 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
30 9a Indoor Worship 10:30a Cowboy Sunday 11:30a Garden Party 6:30p Togolese Community Church 7p SAA	31 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	Notes: To avoid conflicts, please contact Heather in the office before scheduling events and meetings.				

Future Special Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

- July 16-18 – Minnehaha Adventure Camp for youth going into grades 6-7 at Koinonia Retreat Center
- July 23-28 – Minnehaha Wilderness Camp for youth going into grades 8-12 (plus recent graduates) at Star Lake Wilderness Camp
- July 30 – Cowboy Sunday at 10:30 service
- August 6 – Worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30
- August – Collection of school supplies and backpacks for MinneHarvest clients
- August 20 – Blessing of backpacks in worship
- August 27 – Blessing of Animals at 10:30 service
- Sept. 3 – One worship service at 10:00 inside
- Sept. 3 – Weekly Youth programming begins
- Sept. 10 – One worship service at 10:00 outside
- Sept. 11 – Monday night study begins – we will be reading Heart of Christianity by Marcus Borg
- Sept. 14 – Thursday morning study begins – we will be looking at theological elements that are specific to United Methodists
- Sept. 17 – Sunday morning Christian Education begins
- Sept. 17 – First of three Congregational Workshops. 1:00-3:00. A look at the demographics of our neighborhood.
- Oct. 1 – World Communion Sunday with a Caribbean focus
- Oct. 8 – Confirmation Sunday



Greeters, Children's Sunday



RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

R E M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

July 21

**on Sunday, 4th June
We'll celebrate Pentecost
with**

**WORSHIP OUTSIDE at 10am
including a blessing of
bikes and bike helmets**

**Stay afterwards for our first
Garden Party of the Season:
A Potluck Picnic in the Side Yard**

**We'll have information about our new solar
project, projects to do in the garden, yard
games to play, and more.**



**So, bring (or ride!) your bikes (and
helmets), a dish to share, and come
to worship, to eat, and to celebrate!**

www.minnehaha.org

Worship in June & July

This summer, we are looking for God in all the right places! And, what better place than in the movies? Animated Gospel is our theme for June and July, with a different movie featured for each of the weeks. We'll be exploring how the characters inspire us and how the movies teach important lessons, very similar to lessons we find in scripture. See the schedule below for which movies we are focusing on each week.

Also, note that we are celebrating Pentecost on June 4, our graduates on June 11, our second annual Cowboy Sunday will be on July 30, and that on August 6, we will be worshipping at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30.

4th **"God's Spirit"**

Acts 2:1-21

Pentecost, Communion

One Service 10:00 am.

11th **"So Long, Farewell"**

II Corinthians 13:11-13

Graduation, Trinity Sunday

One Service 10:00 am.

18th **Animated Gospel: Up**

Mark 3:31-33

Summer Schedule begins: 9:00 Indoor, 10:30 Outdoor (weather permitting)

25th **Animated Gospel: How to Train Your Dragon**

Mark 8:27-29

July 2 **Animated Gospel: Iron Giant**

Matthew 10:40-42

July 2 **Animated Gospel: Moana**

Genesis 1:1-2, 6-7, 20-21, 31



**JOIN US AT MINNEHAHA FOR OUR SECOND ANNUAL
COWBOY SUNDAY & ALL-CHURCH GRILL OUT IN THE GARDEN**

**WHEN: SUNDAY, 30TH JULY AT SECOND SERVICE — 10:30AM
FOLLOWING WORSHIP, STAY FOR LUNCH & LAWN GAMES**

**WE'LL GRILL OUT — HOT DOGS & COWBOY BEANS
& PEOPLE SHOULD BRING SALADS OR DESSERTS TO SHARE**

HOPE TO SEE Y'ALL HERE!

Youth Ministries

Minnehaha Youth Activities for the Summer:

June 11th - Graduation Sunday We are going to spend the morning celebrating with our high school graduates! They will be announced and recognized during worship at 10:00am, (there is only one Worship service this morning) and then celebrating with a cake reception afterwards at 11:00am. Please invite Family and Friends to join us in the festivities!

June 19th-23rd - Music and Drama Camp - Youth can participate as campers and be in the production, and/or come as Counselors to help! Camp is from 9am-3pm with the children and Counselors will be sticking around until 5pm to work on projects, set up for the next day, and play games together.

June 21st-23rd: Vacation Bible School - Youth will be participating as Group leaders and classroom helpers. Contact Jenia or Lani if you are interested!

July 16th-18th: Adventure Camp at Koinonia Retreat Center - Youth that have finished 5th and 6th grade are invited to join us for two nights at the luxurious Koinonia Retreat center for an amazing camp experience. The youth can look forward to lots of games, and crafts, and spending time outdoors. They will spend a lot of time in the water both swimming, paddle boating, as well as learning how to paddle a canoe. A great time will be had by all. Please contact Lani if you would like more info.

Minnehaha Adventure Camp - Registration deadline is June 15. We are asking this year that people pay half of costs at registration if you can, and have other half paid by the Sunday before camp. All payments are refundable if you need to cancel before June 23rd.

July 23th-28th: Wilderness Camp at Star Lake Campgrounds - Youth that have finished grades 7th-12th are invited to join us for six days of fun in the wilderness! There will be lots of swimming, laughing, canoeing, learning, campfires, amazing food and of course group games! Please contact Lani if you would like more info.

Minnehaha Wilderness Camp - Registration deadline is June 15. We are asking this year that people pay half of costs at registration if you can, and have other half paid by the Sunday before camp. All payments are refundable if you need to cancel before July 1st

Other Summer Events:

We have a few extra summer events in the making. We will announce dates once we get all the details figured out.

- Animal Shelter Volunteering: For Youth that have finished 6th-12th grade
- Drive-in Movie night: For Youth that have finished 6th-12th grade
- Summer Lock-in: for Youth that have finished 5th-12th grade
- Senior High Camping trip: for Youth that have finished 8th-12th grade

Leilani Thompson,
Director of Youth Ministries

Join us for...



Music & Drama Camp

Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp
June 19th-23rd
for children who have completed 3rd-8th grade

Aspiring actors, singers, dancers, set-designers, and fun-seekers are invited to join us. Participants will gather the week of June 19th through the 23rd from 9am to 3:00pm and together will work on all aspects of an original musical production. This year's production will feature the songs and stories of Sandra Boynton.

Learning lines, songs, dances, creating costumes, sets, and props, and working on publicity will give children a chance to develop friendships, to build confidence, to problem solve, and to have a wonderful time! They'll also eat delicious food, play games, and perform a play for family and friends on the evening of Friday, June 23rd

Maureen Trepp, an accomplished Twin Cities actor, director, and educator, leads this camp.

The cost is \$100/camper.
Scholarships are available.



Children's Ministries

Thank you all for a great program year. In the course of the 2016-2017 program year, Minnehaha Children's Ministries reached over 100 children (through Sunday School programming, Wednesday night programming, and Thursday morning playgroup) through the help of over 60 volunteers putting in almost 2000 hours of volunteer time. We stepped into the story: both learning about the story (we're seeking), and also considering how we might be the ones to bring God's love to the world (we're serving and celebrating). The children of Minnehaha created connections with Nokomis Square through Nokomis Connections, led us in worship both on Children's Sunday, and through singing throughout the year; they explored prayer through our Lenten prayer station and joined with people of all ages to create Advent illustrations based on Isaiah. They explored various areas of interest through Choose Your Own Adventure Days, from crocheting and origami, to dog agility training and creating Bags of Hope, working in the garden, making crafts, and more. Many participated in our church's clean up day, and worked diligently to clean the classrooms, hallways, and gathering spaces at Minnehaha. With their parents they participated in a workshop about financial responsibility, and older elementary students also attended the sexuality workshop "My Changing Self" along with peers from Lake Harriet UMC and Richfield UMC. They worshipped together, learned together, played together, ate together, served together, celebrated together: they stepped into the story to make connections with each other and with the world. They helped to make the Minnehaha community a better one. I'm proud of all of their growth, of the love that they show each other and the world, and I am so honored to work with the many adults that help make all of this possible. Thank you.

As we move into summer worship, please keep in mind that during our outside services (June 4th, regular 10:30 services throughout the year, and Rally Day), we will offer child care for children five and younger on the playground. If your child is older than five and goes to the playground, parents are responsible for them, and if it becomes a problem for older children to be there, the child care attendant will ask them to leave. Please have a conversation with your child(ren) before attending service about what appropriate behavior on the playground (while a service is going on feet away!) is: making safe choices, sharing toys and equipment, being respectful of space, and - because of the proximity of worship - keeping volume down.)

Additionally, on the topic of the playground: we know that people's schedule are different during the summers. If you ever happen to be at church on a weekday, please keep in mind that Mandala (the preschool located in our building) uses the playground during the day, and even if they are not on the playground, their classroom is right next to the playground, so we ask people not to use the playground during the school day ('til 6pm). Thanks for your understanding.

As we move into summer programming, there are a few areas I'd like to highlight:

It's indeed to time to register for Vacation Bible School (age 3 through 5th grade) and Music & Drama Camp (3rd through 8th grade) if you haven't already! More information and registration is available both in the narthex and through our website - www.minnehaha.org

- We're also still looking for a few helpers and supply donations for the camps. Please see the supply board in the narthex to find what we need, and to see how you can help!
- Throughout the summer, Becky will be preaching a sermon series on animated movies. Look within this newsletter for information on when we'll be showing this movies at Minnehaha. And, then come as a family to church to watch movies before Becky preaches on them. We'll be viewing *Up*, *How to Train Your Dragon*, *Iron Giant*, *Moana*, *Frozen*, *Finding Nemo*, and *Toy Story*.
- We also encourage you to sign up for a week of helping out in the garden as a family - supplies are provided! Regardless of whether or not you sign up to help, we do encourage you to think of this as your garden. Need some cilantro or oregano for a dish you're making? Stop by the herb garden and get some. And, once tomatoes and peppers and more are ready - feel free to take some for your home!

We've got three garden parties planned this summer. Mark your calendars for this time to come together and socialize, and (we're working on the weather) enjoy our beautiful side lawn. On Sunday, 4th of June and Sunday, 30th of July, the garden parties will be a potluck following service. In August, the Garden Party will be on Tuesday, August 22nd.

We look forward to a fun summer together, and hope everyone gets some relaxing in. Just in case you're anxious for Sunday School to start again - no worries - we'll be launching the 2017-2018 program year before you know it: Sunday, September 10th is Rally Day.

Thanks again for a wonderful year,
Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries

Highlights from the May 9, 2017 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Thanks to your generous giving, we're up-to-date on all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through April 30, 2017. According to our Treasurer, "The church is in a positive, favorable position and moving forward." (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

MUMC SUPPORTS THE MONARCH MILE: The Monarch Mile is a joint project of the Nokomis East Neighborhood Association (NENA) and Metro Blooms to plant a pathway of deep-rooted native flowers on 15 properties along or near 50th Street. It's an effort to beautify our neighborhood and help the environment by creating an area that's ideal for pollinators like bumblebees and Monarch butterflies, and also to slow rainwater runoff. The Council voted to support this project, and Trustees will provide the \$250 - \$300 to pay for the plants to cover a 75 square foot area on the 50th Street boulevard. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

NEW MICROPHONES FOR SPECIAL EVENTS: If you attended Seussical Jr. in the Fellowship Hall in February, you got a taste of what it could be like to amplify the actors' voices so everyone can hear. As a result, Don Mathews put together an estimate of what it would cost for the church to purchase eight microphones for use in plays, musicals, camps, performances, talent shows, special events and more. Thanks to the generosity of the Children's Council, United Methodist Women, Trustees and a special Family Gift, the money was raised and the new microphones should be available by the end of May. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries; Kim Kanuit, Trustees; Maureen Trepp, UMW; Sarah Emrick, Children's Council)

MAY 28 FIRE DRILL: Each year the church conducts a fire drill so we can practice how to evacuate the church in the event of a fire or other emergency. In the event of a fire, everyone must calmly exit the building, go to the Safe Zone on the south lawn (by the raised bed gardens) and wait for the "All Clear." The drill is conducted with the help of Dave Jorgenson of GB Technologies. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair; Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds; Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

SCOUTS GIVE 350 LBS. OF FOOD TO FOOD SHELF: On Saturday, April 29, the Scouts from Pack One completed their Food Pick Up and delivered 350 lbs. of non-perishable foods to the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Thanks, Pack One! (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

FIRST GRADERS VISIT THE FOOD SHELF: On Tuesday, May 9, 21 first graders from Wenonah Elementary School made their annual visit to the Food Shelf—along with 602 lbs. of food they'd collected. The kids carried in the food, helped stack food on shelves and organized registration cards. They also read "The Very Hungry Caterpillar" book and made their own foods booklet. This all ties in with a Foods Unit in their classroom. Thanks to George Gallagher, Judy Durfey, Lil Grothe and the entire Food Shelf team for making this a special experience for the first graders. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

LEARNING ABOUT DIFFERENT RELIGIONS: Plans are in the works for ways to educate children, their families, and our congregation about different religions. We'll visit mosques and synagogues and more in a journey to understand many different faiths. Look for upcoming information. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

JUNE 11 IS BACCALAUREATE SUNDAY: During and after the single 10:00 AM worship service on June 11, we'll celebrate our high school graduates with gifts, cake and lots of photos and videos of them growing up at Minnehaha UMC. We hope you can join us in the celebration (Lani Thompson, Youth Ministries)

YOUTH ROOM IS UNDER CONSTRUCTION: Minnehaha's youth are updating the Youth Room (a.k.a., the "Upper Room" or Room #304 on the Third Floor) with a new coat of paint, new furniture, a TV and more. Take a look to see how it's going! (Lani Thompson, Youth Ministries)

INVENTORY OF VOLUNTEER HOURS: We're trying to identify how many volunteer hours go into running the church. That way we can show all the things that are going on at Minnehaha UMC and let

Continued on pg. 7

Continued from pg. 6

future volunteers know how much time might be required to do each activity. Children's Ministries figures that a total of 1,787 volunteer hours go into a standard year of children's programming—thanks to 65 volunteers (2/3 of those take on multiple roles). If you'd like to volunteer to help teach Sunday school, help with the Food Shelf or MinneHarvest, serve on a committee, make and serve coffee between services, cut the grass, cook meals and more, just ask. Thank you, volunteers! (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

NEW PHOTO DIRECTORY: After many (many) years, Minnehaha UMC is putting together a new photo directory. We're trying to include everyone in our church family. If you haven't scheduled your photo, had your picture taken or submitted a photo, contact the church office. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

NO COUNCIL MEETING IN JULY: There will be no Church Council meeting in July. The next meetings will be June 13 and August 8 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Wear Red!

Pentecost is the celebration of the birthday of the church, and it is traditional to wear red that day (red symbolizes the flames of the Holy Spirit). This year, we will celebrate Pentecost on June 4 (remember, one service at 10:00 that day, outside), so come and wear some red!

Rummage Sale

The MUMC Rummage Sale will be on Saturday, June 17th from 8:00-4:00, as part of the Nokomis East Neighborhood sales. Donate high quality housewares, linens, tools, camping gear, books, toys, and childrens clothing & shoes. Nothing ripped, broken, or non-working, please! Donations can be dropped off June 4th-16th on the stage in the Fellowship Hall. Sign up in the narthex to help sort and price goods on Tuesday-Friday evenings or work the day of the sale on June 17th. This is a labor-intensive week, but a good money maker for our church! Questions? Contact Kate Stower at stow-er.schlosser@gmail.com or Jenny Ammerman at jennyammerman@comcast.net.

What's Up Zak?



Hope Hutchison Being Commissioned

Many thank-yous to all who plotted and planned the salad luncheon and the fun birthday celebration. Ps, sorry I won't be able to help with the *next* one for those who will be in their "golden 90's."

Audrey Damon

Happy Birthday to June Swenson! She reaches the 100 year mark on June 13!



If you were at our Annual Meeting in January, you voted to continue the candidacy of Hope Hutchison as a candidate for ministry. That is the last time we will take that vote, because Hope was approved by the Board of Ordained Ministry in February, and she will be commissioned on the deacon track at our Annual Conference on Wednesday, June 21 at 7:00 p.m. at the St. Cloud Convention Center.

We commission people as probationary members, ask them to serve for 2 years, and then consider them for full membership, ordaining them once they have been approved in that second round of

examination. So, while Hope passes from our care to the care of the Board of Ordained Ministry, she will be commissioned, not ordained, this June and will need to continue to be considered again in order to be ordained. In addition, we ordain people on two different tracks. There are ordained elders, most of whom you just think of as pastors. Becky is an elder, and generally, elders serve as pastors, caring for the breadth of the work of the church. There are also ordained deacons. Deacons are specialists, and some serve in churches, focusing on an areas like Christian education or music and worship. Some serve in areas outside of the church, linking their work with the work of the church. They might be social workers, lawyers, community activists, etc. Hope is on the deacon track, and her area of fo-

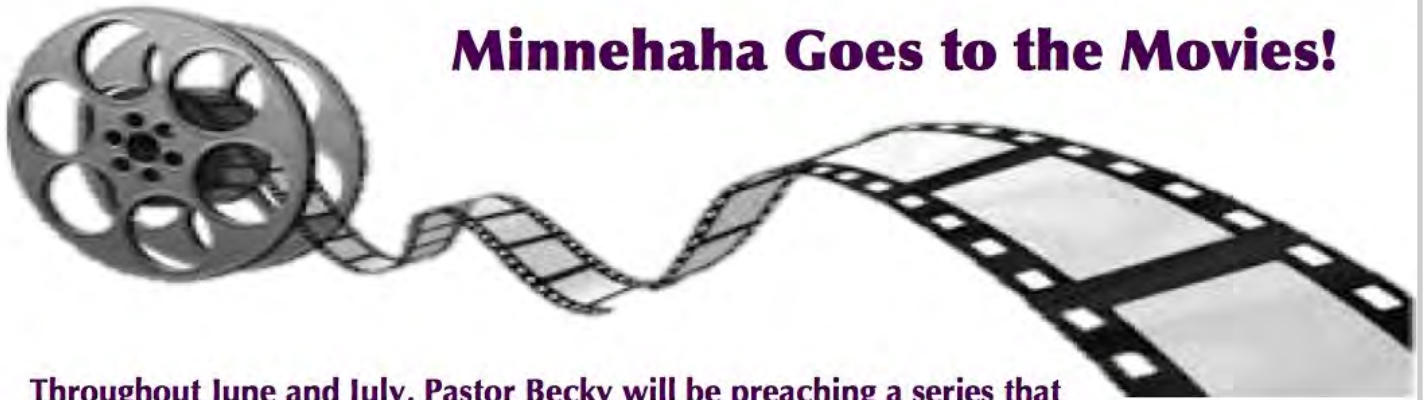
cus is environmental justice. She has a job starting in June at a camp/retreat center in Wisconsin. She is in charge of their garden as they work to do more farm to table in their dining hall and connect some of their camps and retreats to environmental issues and gardening. She will continue to maintain her official connection to the United Methodist Church through Minnehaha.

Also, Cooper Wiggen is Retiring!

Rev. Cooper Wiggen, pastor at Minnehaha 2005-2014 is retiring. He will be recognized and celebrated at Annual Conference this year at the same service where Hope is being commissioned. So, come up to St. Cloud on Wednesday, June 21 at 7:00 p.m. to celebrate Cooper's retirement and Hope's commissioning.

Anna Weiglein was baptized May 14





Minnehaha Goes to the Movies!

Throughout June and July, Pastor Becky will be preaching a series that reflects on a variety of animated films.

We invite you to join us to view the movies with us in the days leading up to the sermons.

See the schedule below for when movies will be shown at Minnehaha – all ages are welcome!

Up

Viewing: Friday, 16th June at 6:30pm

Sermon: Sunday, 18th June

How to Train Your Dragon

Viewing: Saturday, 24th June at 9:30am

Sermon: Sunday, 25th June

Iron Giant

Viewing: Thursday, June 29th at 6:30 p.m.

Sermon: Sunday, 2nd July

Moana

Viewing: Saturday, July 8 at 7:00 p.m.

Sermon: Sunday, 9th July

Frozen

Viewing: Friday, 14th July at 6:30p.m.

Sermon: Sunday, 16th July

Finding Nemo

Viewing: Thursday, 20th July at 6:30pm

Sermon: Sunday, 23rd July

Toy Story

Viewing: Friday, 28th July at 6:30pm

Sermon: Sunday, 30th July



Love Offering Supports Emma Norton, Sierra Leone, Scholarships

Each year, churches in the Minnesota Annual Conference take a Love Offering for missions. The offering is brought to annual conference session – a gathering of United Methodist clergy and laity from across the state.

Donations to the 2016 Love Offering totaled more than \$96,000.

Refugee Services (of the Minnesota Council of Churches) received 40%

United Methodist Committee on Relief received 10% to cover the cost of shipping more than 13,000 health kids that Minnesota churches assembled

International Child Care in the Dominican Republic received 40%

Volunteers in Mission scholarships received 10%.

This year, the Love Offering will go to three projects:

United Methodist University of Sierra Leone – 60%

Sierra Leone has one of the lowest life expectancies in the world, and 1 in every 5 children dies before their 5th birthday. In addition, the vast majority of the country's citizens don't have access to health services and there is an acute shortage of trained health professions. Through the Love Offering, the United Methodist University will create a School of Applied Health Sciences which will train a wide variety of health professionals from midwives to nurses to community health officers to technicians.



What: Vacation Bible School

Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When: Wednesday, June 21st-Friday, June 23rd, 9-11:30 am (Extended Care available)
Who: Children - age 3 (as of June 1st) through 5th grade (completed June 2017)

**Cost: \$25/child or \$40/family,
Scholarships Available**

At Hero Central, students enjoy a variety of interactive, energizing activities that help them uncover their own strengths. Through games, music, crafts, science, snack, and time together, we'll celebrate what makes them strong and how they can use their strength to take care of each other and the world!

Emma Norton Services (located in St. Paul) – 30%

Emma Norton helps women, children, and families achieve victory over homelessness, mental illness, and chemical dependency. They provide safe, affordable housing through Emma Norton Residence, which supports 50 women in transition at any given time, and Emma's Place, which houses 13 families on a permanent basis. In addition to housing, Emma Norton Services provides case management, peer and individual support programs, and a variety of other programs to help women and families get the coaching and resources they need to equip them on their path toward stability.

Volunteers in Mission Scholarships – 10%

Mission trips transform the lives of participants by giving them an opportunity to grow in faith and gain a new perspective of the world. Team members pay their own way, but the Love Offering helps offset the cost for first-time participants.

To contribute to the Love Offering, please mark "Love Offering" on your check and either mail it to the church office or put it in the offering plate by June 11.



United
Methodist
Women

United Methodist Women

We had a lovely salad luncheon on May 6 to celebrate our Greatest Generation; please look for your special edition of our newsletter to read all about it. We also served dinner at Simpson Housing Services on May 22 successfully. Day Circles will be having an annual picnic lunch on Wed., June 14 at Waubun; please bring your own lunch and beverage at 11:30 and enjoy our beautiful Minnesota weather (hopefully).

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Sq.

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. In June and July we will be gathering on June 8 & July 13.

Blessing of Bikes (and helmets)

June 4 will be a special service to bless bikes and bike helmets. We'll be having one worship service at 10:00, outside, and a potluck picnic following the service. You can ride your bike to church, bring your bike, or just bring your bike helmet and we'll make sure whatever you bring gets a blessing.

Volunteers Needed

Riverview Senior Housing (5360 Riverview Rd.) is in need of a few volunteers to help bring back affordable food. Until recently, Second Harvest Heartland had been bringing over a truck of food two times a month. Residents carried the food in, set up tables for distribution, and then cleaned up after the distribution. But the current residents are no longer physically able to unload the food from the truck, so the program is on hiatus. If you would be willing to help unload the truck two times a month (the times and dates will have to be re-negotiated with Second Harvest), or to help with clean up (mainly taking down tables and putting things away), please let Becky know right away. Thank you!

New Affordable Housing

A number of years ago, Minnehaha UMC worked with Beacon Interfaith Housing in the creation of Riverview Senior Housing (5360 Riverview Road). Currently a CommonBond property, Riverview has 42 units of rent-assisted senior housing. This summer, Minnehaha Townhomes will be added to the location. This will consist of 16 units of public housing, and will house families coming out of homeless shelters or in danger of entering the shelter system. There will be one 4-bedroom townhome, eleven 3-bedroom townhomes, and four 2-bedroom townhomes. The townhomes will be built between the existing Riverview building and Hiawatha, with plans for shared green space and a community garden. There are also plans for intergenerational programs between the two buildings once families are in place. It's exciting to see how dreams can continue to grow!

Picture Directory

We are doing our own photo directory! Jonathan Conklin has graciously agreed to take all our pictures, and we'll put them together into a picture directory. Picture taking days are Sunday, June 11, Monday, June 12, and Tuesday, June 13. Come to the church between 4 and 7 on Monday or Tuesday or after church on Sunday to have your picture taken. It should be a brief process. If you are in church over the next 2 Sundays, we'll also have sign-up sheets to help speed along the process, but if you forget to sign up, just show up in one of those time frames and we'll do our best to fit you in.

Just a note -- Jonathan is only taking pictures for the directory, so pictures are not available for purchase.

Potluck Lunch

We are kicking off summer with a potluck following the worship service on June 4 (one service that day, 10:00, outside). Bring a main dish, side dish, or dessert to share with others. Kids are welcome to play on the playground, and everyone is welcome to admire the raised garden beds. You can see what's growing, pay attention to what flowers are about to bloom, and pick any weeds you find. If it's raining, we'll move the whole thing into the Fellowship Hall. Our next potluck picnic will be on Sunday, July 30, following the second service (which is also Cowboy Sunday!).

Pride Parade

June is the month for celebrating LGBTQ Pride all over the nation, and the parade and festival in the Twin Cities will be Saturday and Sunday, June 24-25. The Festival is held at Loring Park, and you can go there anytime from 10-10 on Saturday or 10-6 on Sunday. You'll find concerts, food vendors, booths for companies and organizations, and so much more. Their webpage, TCPride.org will give you all the information. If you go, look for the Reconciling Congregations booth. The Parade is on Sunday and kicks off at 11:00 a.m. The United Methodist Reconciling Congregations have a marching contingent as well as a float, and members of reconciling congregations are welcome to join in however they can. The units line up on 3rd Street, facing Hennepin Ave. and the parade goes down Hennepin until it reaches Loring Park. You can find our unit number (which will aid in finding our group more quickly) on the pride web page a couple days prior to the parade. We recommend wearing your Minnehaha T-shirts (if you have one) and bringing some Hershey's kisses to hand out to people along the parade route. If you are planning on being part of the parade, let Becky know so she can give you any last minute changes or information.



The Paint-A-Thon needs you!!

If you can wave your hand while holding a paint brush then you can help!

Come join your fellow MUMC members in painting the exterior of a senior citizen's home in the South Mpls area so that they can continue living with dignity and independence in their own home. Lunch and equipment will be provided however all ladders and stepstools are welcomed.

When: August 5-6th either or both days.

Where: South Mpls



July 4th - 1-4pm

St. James on the Parkway, Episcopal Church, 3225 E. Minnehaha Pkwy, Minneapolis, MN 55417

One block west of 34th Avenue on the south side of Minnehaha Parkway.

Activities for the whole family / fellowship and community building / food trucks

Guest appearances by Regina Marie Williams, Ali Gray, Mark Bloom and Brother Ali

Sponsored by



The Episcopal Church of
St. James on the Parkway

NCJ

MINN





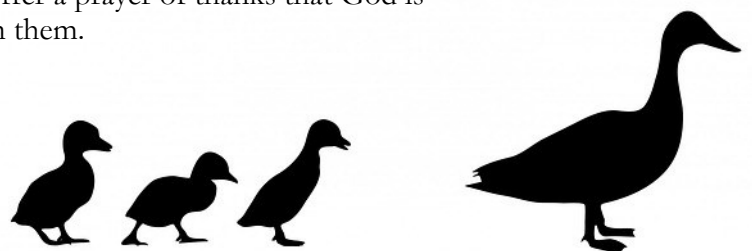
Goslings

I saw my first goslings this year in mid-May. I always enjoy seeing both the goslings and the ducklings as their parents first let them leave the nest. Whereas I am blasé about their parents (after all, Canadian geese and Mallards are a dime a dozen in our urban landscape), I will stop and gape as the goslings and ducklings. They're all fuzzy and tiny in these early days. Their scampering across lawns and beaches is adorable, and I could watch them bob and run/swim across the water for long periods of time. Their development happens over the course of the summer, and they have much to learn in that time. They will learn how to swim, how to identify predators, and how to cross busy streets. As their downy fuzz gives way to adult plumage, they will learn how to fly. They'll stop being cute sometime in mid-summer, and by fall, it will be hard to tell them from the other adults of their flock. But they will keep learning, keep growing, until they are the parents next year, teaching a new generation how to swim, stay away from predators, and fly.

It's not that unlike our own development. Thankfully, we get more than just one summer to learn everything. And, our spiritual development can last our entire lifetime. Long past the stage where our feet are still growing, we will still discover new things about God and God's communities. Our development isn't as linear as it is for the ducklings and goslings either. Things we thought we knew about God when we were 5 will get questioned when we are 10. And, discoveries at age 10 might get tossed out the window and replaced with new understandings at 15. Changes in the world around us at 20 might cause us to re-think it all again, and a personal event at 25 might push us back to reclaim something our 5-year old self knew. Life might get in the way of our spiritual development at 30, but by 35 we realize something is missing and begin a new exploration of old concepts, and so on. And, all along the way, we are also helping others to develop their own faith. We don't have to know it all to accompany others on their journey. In fact, the richness of communities of faith comes from a variety of people in a variety of places in their faith journey, with a variety of experiences that impact and inform them. Sometimes, 5 year old and 10 years and 15 year olds have something to teach 75 and 80 year olds. And, I know that at 27, in my first congregation as a pastor, I learned some invaluable life and faith lessons from 90 year olds. Edna Nolan, who was bed-bound, ready to die (and had been for years), and thought she had no useful purpose left in life has a special pillar in the architecture of my faith. I only hope that she found at least half the spiritual development in our relationship that I did.

Spiritual development is not like shoe size. It might happen slowly, in a flash of inspiration, in a straight line, or in curly Qs. But it is always happening. As I watch the goslings and ducklings grow up this summer, I know that I will offer a prayer of thanks that God is working in me at least as much as God is working in them.

In joy,
Becky





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6/17



is joining in with NENA

(Nokomis East Neighborhood Association)

Annual Garage Sale Day!
Saturday, June 17, 2017

8:00am-4:00pm!

Volunteers Needed – Sign-up in the Narthex!!

High-Quality Donations Accepted / June 4-16
(Please put them on the stage in Fellowship Hall)

- Housewares / Linens
- Tools / Camping Gear
- Toys / Books / Sporting Equipment
- Children's Clothing & Shoes
- Nothing ripped, broken or non-working

